PART IX · BEYOND THE LEVELS

Going further

The notes that decorate a tune, the scales older and newer than major and minor, and moving a whole piece into another key. Read them when your pieces ask for them.

IN THIS PART

Notes outside the chord 175
Modes and other scales (coming) .....
Transposition (coming) .....

PART IX · GOING FURTHER · 1

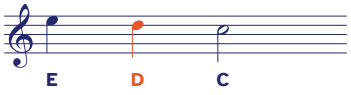
Notes outside the chord

Under a tune, the chord holds the main notes. The other notes of the tune are **non-chord notes**: they lean on the chord for a moment, then step back into it. Name them, and you know which notes to shape and which to rest on.

THE SECRET

A note outside the chord moves by step: into the chord, out of it, or both.

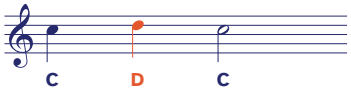
Passing note



over C

steps **between** two chord notes

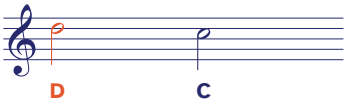
Auxiliary note



over C

steps **out and back** to the same note

Appoggiatura



over C

leans on the beat, then steps into the chord

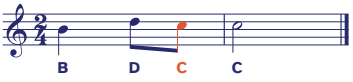
Suspension



F chord, then C

is **held over** from the last chord, then falls

Anticipation



G chord, then C

arrives **early**, before its chord

Five ways out of the chord and back. Red: outside the chord.

1. Name the **chord** under the bar: its three notes.
2. Mark every tune note that is **not** one of them.
3. Look how it **moves in and out**: that gives its name.

The five at a glance

NAME	HOW IT MOVES	BEAT	ALSO CALLED
Passing note	steps between two chord notes, going the same way	usually weak	—
Auxiliary note	steps away from a chord note and back to it	usually weak	neighbour note
Appoggiatura	lands on the strong beat and leans, then steps into the chord	strong	from Italian *appoggiare*, to lean
Suspension	held over from the last chord, then falls by step	strong	prepared, held, resolved
Anticipation	a note of the next chord, sounded early	weak	—

PART IX · GOING FURTHER · 1 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE

Which notes are outside the chord? The chord is C



1 **The chord is C**: C, E and G.

2 **Mark every note** that is not C, E or G.

3 **How does each one move?**

A and B: two passing notes from G up to C (B falls on beat 3, and still passes). In bar 2, D passes from E down to C.

GAME

Name it

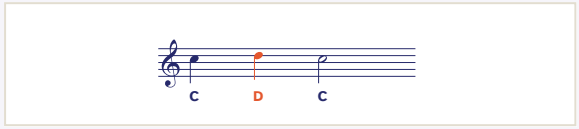


1 2 3 4

Passing, auxiliary, appoggiatura or suspension? The chord is C (in 4: F, then C).

Answer: 1 passing · 2 auxiliary · 3 appoggiatura · 4 suspension

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS



Play C D C, then C B C, over a C chord.

Out and straight back: two auxiliary notes.

YOU KNOW THIS

Ode to Joy (Beethoven)



Bar 1 sits on C (C E G). The **F** steps from E up to G: a **passing note**.

Try it. Play bar 1 with a C chord in the left hand and hear the F slip between E and G.

THINK OF IT Stepping stones in a stream: the chord is the bank. Step onto a stone for a moment, then land on the bank again.

TRAP

× Calling a note outside the chord a mistake: it is the tune's colour. It almost always moves by step.

× Choosing a chord for a passing note: choose for the main notes.

SEE ALSO

Chords under a melody p. 142 · Chords in a key p. 116 · Ornaments p. 88

PRACTISE IT

Workbook pp. 1–2 · Online: Library › Non-chord notes